OZARK CHRISTIAN COLLEGE I OCTOBER 26

People First Leadership in a World That Wants to Forget

Thirty-three years of building teams. One idea held up.

THE IDEA

“If you grow people, you grow the organization.
If you use people, you lose it.”

Bart Paden

YOU ALREADY KNOW THIS

Think of one person who made you better.

A teacher.	**A coach.**	**A boss.**	**A friend.**

Turn to the person next to you. Tell them who it was and what they did.

WHAT THEY HAD IN COMMON

They gave you three things.

01

They paid attention to you.

02

They believed in you before you earned it.

03

They wanted you to win.

That is servant leadership. You have been on the receiving end of it already.



YOU ARE ALREADY LEADING

Look at where people follow you.

Group projects	**Teams**	**Jobs**	**Friends who look to you**

Nobody gave you a title. People follow you anyway. You choose what that looks like.



SERVING COMES FIRST

“The Servant as Leader”

Robert Greenleaf gave his work that title.

Serving first. Leading second.

IN GREENLEAF'S WORDS

"The servant-leader is servant first… It begins with the natural feeling that one wants to serve, to serve first. Then conscious choice brings one to aspire to lead."

Robert K. Greenleaf, *The Servant as Leader*, 1970

GREENLEAF'S BEST TEST

Do those served grow as people?

Do they, while being served, become healthier, wiser, freer, more autonomous, more likely themselves to become servants?

Adapted from Robert K. Greenleaf, *The Servant as Leader*, 1970

THE PULL THE OTHER WAY

The world rewards scoreboards.

Scoreboards	**Followers**	**Grades**	**Titles**

Those things are fine. But they pull you toward using people.

People first is a choice you make again and again.

THIS WEEK

What it looks like this week

01

Learn one person’s name and one thing they care about.

02

Ask a teammate how they are, then listen.

03

Give credit away.

04

Say “I was wrong” once.

None of this takes a title. All of it counts.



TAKE THIS WITH YOU

Faith.
Curiosity.
Humility.

ONE QUESTION

Who did I make better this week?

PEOPLE FIRST

If you grow people, you grow the organization.

You are going to lead someone soon. Make them glad they followed you.

KEEP THE CONVERSATION GOING

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This talk, the slides and Archy